PRELUDE X

BACH first wrote this Prelude as a piece 23 bars long, with a right hand consisting of nothing but quaver chords twice in each bar. In this form the movement would be fairly fast and the character might be energetic; but the addition of the present florid *cantabile* changes the whole first 22 bars to a movement like the first movement of the E major Sonata for cembalo and violin, or the G minor Prelude in the present First Book. The very important definite readings given in bars 5, 7, 9, and 11 by Bach's pupils show that under his own teaching the later tendency was to keep these 22 bars rather slower than the pace indicated by the first readings; and only in bar 11 is the earlier reading harmonically better. All reasonable criticism will allow the player to make his own selection from any of these readings.

The sign ~ here always means an ordinary long trill, to which in bar 14 the ordinary turn may be supplied before the demisemiquavers, or the trill may stop, without turn, on the dot. In bar 20 the trill stops on the dot, which may as well be treated as a double dot; thus, 

In bars 10 and 12 the rest between the shake and its written-out turn indicates a beautiful clavichord effect—viz., the vanishing of the shake in a *pianissimo* which should stimulate the ambition of the finest Chopin-player. The *appoggiatura* in bar 9 is, as indicated, a full-sized quaver.

The momentary crossing of parts indicated in the first chord of bar 15 shows that Bach conceives these chords as including the bass notes (apart from the intervening semiquavers), and he therefore here avoids making octaves with the bass. The bass-notes may, then, legitimately be held as quavers, all the more since the whole scheme of the movement consists in the steady descent of this bass for twenty steps, from bar 5 to 20. It is odd that Bach did not think of crossing the parts in bar 9.

The second part, marked *Presto* (to be treated as a quick but not precipitous movement), repeats the whole scheme in miniature; first asserting the key of A minor (bars 23-26) in the same four harmonies as those which assert the tonic at the beginning of this and of all Bach's arpeggio preludes; and thence proceeding for twelve steps (two in the bar, twice as fast as the average of the first movement) downwards, till E minor is re-established in bar 32. After this it quickly proceeds to a dominant pedal on which it builds a great climax.

FUGUE X

THIS, the only two-part Fugue in *Das Wohltemperirte Klavier*, is, like so many of Bach's two-part Preludes and Inventions, entirely in Double Counterpoint. As the Countersubject accompanies the Answer in bars 3-4, so Episode 1 accompanies the Countersubject twice in bars 5-9. Episode 2 (bars 15-18) is an antiphonal dialogue on a new twin-figure, culminating in a sudden burst into octaves (bar 19). The rest of the Fugue consists in the reversal in Double Counterpoint of the whole first 19 bars, starting in A minor (bar 20), changing the modulation and the mode at bar 29 (=bar 10) so as to arrive at the octave-bar in the tonic (bar 38), after which the Fugue bubbles away in four bars of Coda.

The Subject, very difficult to play in close *legato*, responds excellently to a light finger-*staccato*, against which the Countersubject can sing in *legato cantabile*, while all quavers should be an ordinary *staccato*. The *tempo* should be that suggested by the proposed finger-*staccato*—*i.e.*, lively, but not headlong. The touch of a Mendelssohn *Scherzo* is appropriate.

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